Lab 01 - Visual Brief and Layout Exploration

Course: Canva Design Masterclass (C156) Version: v1.0 | 30 September 2026

Scenario

Create a workplace heat-exhaustion awareness visual that can be understood quickly by staff.

Objective

Translate a communication need into a visual brief and two layout directions.

Supplied image files

- heat-exhaustion-template.png
- layout-reference-01.png
- layout-reference-02.png

Detailed procedure

1. Open the supplied template image and create a new Canva design that matches its aspect ratio.
2. Write a one-sentence brief naming audience, primary message, action and viewing context.
3. Create a named baseline page before editing.
4. Build Layout A with a dominant warning headline, one focal image area and a clear action zone.
5. Duplicate the page and create Layout B by changing only the grid and focal position.
6. Run a five-second hierarchy test with a partner and record the first three items noticed.
7. Select the stronger direction, state why it fits the brief and export a high-quality JPEG.

Evidence to retain

Brief, two layout variants, five-second test note and final JPEG.

Acceptance criteria

[ ] The primary message is noticed first.

[ ] Alignment and spacing follow a repeatable grid.

[ ] The action is visible without competing elements.

[ ] The final image exports at the intended size.

Reflection prompts

- Which decision most improved the message or focal hierarchy?
- Which visible design decision most improved the audience's understanding?
- What source, permission or provenance evidence must accompany the finished image?